

TIME SIGNATURES: Next to the clef sign (at the beginning of a composition), locate the two numbers (like a fraction) or a symbol that represents these numbers. The top number tells how many beats (or counts) in a measure, and the bottom number indicates what kind of note gets one beat.

EXAMPLE: $\frac{4}{4}$ means four quarters, or four beats per measure, with a quarter note receiving one beat or *count*. The symbol is **C** .

Notes in the First Position

No sharps or flats—Key of C major.

Order of the notes going up the scale:
 A B C D E F G, A B C D E F G, A B...
 Start at any point and read left to right.

	C	D	E	F	G	A	B	C
frets and fingers	3	0	2	3	0	2	0	1

strings (5) count 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 etc. (3) (2)

1 0 2 3 2 0 3 0 3

(2) (3) (4) (5)

EXERCISE 1

3 0 2 3

2 3 0 2

0 2 0 1

count 1 2 3 4

■ Read the *notes*, not the fingering. Fingering numbers will eventually be omitted.

■ EXERCISE 2

3 2 0 3 2 1

hold notes down

■ EXERCISE 3

3 4 2

■ EXERCISE 4

count 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 etc.